



SPONSOR: Rep. K. Williams & Sen. Pinkney

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
153rd GENERAL ASSEMBLY

HOUSE BILL NO. 264

AN ACT TO AMEND TITLE 16 RELATING TO THE CHILDHOOD LEAD POISONING PREVENTION ADVISORY COMMITTEE.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF DELAWARE:

Section 1. Amend § 2605, Title 16 of the Delaware Code by making deletions as shown by strike through and insertions as shown by underline as follows and by redesignating accordingly:

§ 2605. Childhood Lead Poisoning Prevention Advisory Committee.

(c) The Committee consists of the following:

(1) The Secretary of the Department of Education.

(2) The Secretary of the Department of Health and Social Services.

(3) The Secretary of the Department of Services for Children, Youth & their Families.

(4) The Director of the Delaware State Housing Authority.

(5) The President of the Delaware Association of School Administrators.

(6) The President of the Delaware Association of Realtors.

(7) A Delaware pediatric provider, appointed by the Governor.

(8) Five members, appointed by the Governor, with at least 1 from each county.

(9) One member, appointed by the Speaker of the House of Representatives.

(10) One member, appointed by the President Pro Tempore of the Senate.

(11) One member who is a school nurse in this State, appointed by the Speaker of the House of Representatives. The Delaware School Nurse Association may provide a list of potential nominees, which the Speaker of the House may consider.

SYNOPSIS

School nurses are a vital link in implementing the Childhood Lead Poisoning Prevention Act and in preventing lead poisoning among Delaware's children. Since the 1990s, school nurses have been on the front lines of ensuring that students entering pre-kindergarten and kindergarten have a lead screening completed prior to the start of school.

The Delaware School Nurse Association (DSNA) Advocacy Committee has actively participated in the Childhood Lead Poisoning Prevention Advisory Committee (CLPPAC) as a stakeholder, collaborating to improve blood lead testing rates and to address racial, ethnic, and socioeconomic disparities in lead poisoning. School nurses also contribute to the development, updating, and implementation of the statewide screening plan. Most importantly, when a child tests positive for an elevated blood lead level, school nurses are uniquely positioned to connect that student and family with the academic and health resources needed for success.

This Act adds a school nurse as a member on the CLPPAC. The presence of a school nurse as a voting member will strengthen the Committee's work and ensure that the voices of those most directly supporting children are represented in both policy and practice.